

To share folders in VirtualBox, you first need to create or designate a folder on your host machine. Then, within VirtualBox's settings for the guest machine, you add the shared folder, specifying its path, name, and whether it should be read-only or have auto-mount enabled. Finally, you might need to access the shared folder within the guest OS, possibly using a network drive or a file explorer command.

Detailed Steps:

Create/Select Host Folder: On your host machine (the machine running VirtualBox), create a folder or choose an existing one that you want to share with the guest virtual machine.

Access Guest Machine Settings: Open VirtualBox Manager and select the guest machine you want to share files with. Click on "Settings".

Go to Shared Folders: In the settings, navigate to the "Shared Folders" section.

Add Shared Folder: Click the "+" button to add a new shared folder.

Configure Folder Path: In the "Folder Path" field, select the host folder you created in step 1. You can either browse to it or enter the full path.

Configure Folder Name: Enter a name for the shared folder that will be visible in the guest operating system.

Set Read-Only (Optional): Check the "Read-Only" box if you don't want the guest to be able to modify files in the shared folder.

Set Auto-Mount (Optional): Check the "Auto-Mount" box if you want the shared folder to be automatically mounted when the guest machine starts.

Set Mount Point (Optional): If you're using an older version of VirtualBox, you may need to specify a mount point in the guest OS. However, if you have auto-mount enabled, you can leave this field blank.

Start Guest Machine: Start the guest virtual machine.

Access Shared Folder in Guest OS:

Windows Guest: You should see the shared folder under the "Network" location in File Explorer.

Linux Guest: You might need to use a terminal command like `sudo mount -t vboxsf SharedFolder /path/to/mount/point` or browse the shared folder through a file manager.

macOS Guest: The shared folder should be accessible through Finder by navigating to the Network location.